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MKT 101: Principles of Marketing - Customers, Value and the Marketing Mix

Think like a marketer about real Nigerian markets, not just definitions

FACULTY PRIMER

Faculty Primer

Faculty of Management Sciences
Marketing | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Why this pack exists

Marketing is often reduced to advertising, which is like reducing medicine to injections. This pack explains value, exchange, segmentation, positioning and the extended marketing mix, using Nigerian campus and consumer examples you can analyse in assignments.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Define marketing as value creation and exchange rather than promotion alone.
- Segment a market and choose a defensible target segment and position.
- Apply the 4Ps and 7Ps to a real product or service.
- Explain consumer buying behaviour and the factors that shape it.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Marketing is not advertising

Marketing begins with understanding a need and ends with a satisfied customer, profitably.

- Needs are basic requirements; wants are culturally shaped desires; demand is the willingness and ability to buy.
- Value is the difference between what a customer gets and what they give up.
- Exchange requires two parties, something of value, communication and freedom to accept or reject.
- Marketing orientation starts with the customer; production orientation starts with the factory.
- Customer satisfaction and retention are cheaper than constant acquisition.

- Marketing ethics matter: manipulation and false claims destroy trust and invite regulation.

STP: segment, target, position

You cannot serve everybody well. Choose deliberately.

1. Segment the market using demographic, geographic, psychographic or behavioural variables.
2. Evaluate segments by size, growth, profitability, accessibility and fit with your capability.
3. Select one or more target segments and state why.
4. Choose a positioning statement: for whom, what benefit, against which alternative.
5. Test the positioning for clarity, credibility and distinctiveness.
6. Ensure the marketing mix actually delivers the promised position.

> **Positioning is a promise**
> If you position on low price, your cost structure must support it. If you position on quality, your product and service must consistently prove it.

The marketing mix and consumer behaviour

The mix is the set of controllable tools used to deliver value in the target market.

- Product: features, quality, branding, packaging, after-sales service.
- Price: cost-plus, value-based, penetration and skimming strategies.
- Place: channels, coverage, logistics and retailer relationships.
- Promotion: advertising, sales promotion, public relations, personal selling and digital marketing.
- For services, extend with people, process and physical evidence.
- Buying behaviour is shaped by culture, social groups, personal factors and psychological factors such as perception and motivation.

Marketing is exchange, not advertising

Marketing is the activity of creating, communicating and delivering value to a chosen market at a profit. Advertising is one tool within it. A business that advertises a product nobody wants has a marketing failure, not an advertising one.

The marketing concept holds that the customer's need should organise the business, subject to profitability. This is not altruism: it is a claim about which orientation survives competition. Production orientation assumes supply is the constraint; product orientation assumes quality sells itself; selling orientation assumes persuasion is the constraint; marketing orientation assumes understanding the customer is.

The marketing environment is analysed with PESTLE (political, economic, social, technological, legal, environmental) and with Porter's five forces for competitive pressure. These frameworks are only useful if you fill them with specific facts about a specific market.